



Discussion Guide: Gregory Ellison

A Picture of an Activist?

Reflect

- During his talk, Greg shows a picture of three activists on the front lines of protest in Ferguson, MO, and emphasizes his realization that he was not one of them. Describe a time when you felt defined more by who you are not than who you are. What was this experience like? Was it disorienting or did it help clarify your sense of purpose?
- Greg draws our attention to Howard Thurman's classic book, [Jesus and the Disinherited](#). In it, Thurman describes three ways of interacting with a secular culture that were prominent in Jesus' day: assimilation (like the Sadducees), isolationism (like the Pharisees), and revolt (like the Zealots). What are the strengths and weaknesses of each approach when it comes to engaging with the world around us today?
- Which of the three ways of interacting with secular culture named above best describes your way of being in the world? Why do you tend to operate in this mode?

Respond

- Rather than feeling discouraged that we are not one of "the greats," Greg encourages us to find the ways to discover "the kingdom of God within us" – that is, our own authentic role in the fight for freedom. Describe the role you feel called to play when it comes to matters of social justice, equity, and compassion in the world.
- What issues in the area of social justice are most relevant to your faith community? How is your faith community working to address these issues? What progress has been made and what obstacles stand in the way of continued progress?